Mosquito Hunters

Franchise Decision Report

Source: 2025 Franchise Disclosure Document

Filed with the Wisconsin Department of Financial Institutions

Legal entity: Mosquito Hunters, LLC

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Executive Summary

Mosquito Hunters is the smallest system in the mosquito pest control cohort (135 franchised outlets) and the only brand structured as a combination franchise — bundling mosquito control, general pest control (Pest Hunters), and holiday lighting (Humbug). This diversification is the single most distinctive feature of the brand: it directly addresses the seasonality problem that every mosquito franchise faces.

The Item 19 provides 7 tables of operational data — customer counts, treatment pricing, customer values by region, and holiday lighting revenue — but **does not disclose gross revenue or profitability per franchise unit**. This means the most fundamental number a buyer needs (how much money does this business make?) must be triangulated from indirect data. The triangulation is possible and produces plausible estimates, but it is inference, not disclosure.

The system health story is one of genuine turnaround. Hunters contracted in 2022 (−4 net) and 2023 (−1), then reversed sharply in 2024 (+13, zero terminations). The 3-year net of +8 is modest, but the trajectory — from 17 terminations in 2022 to zero in 2024 — is the most dramatic stability improvement in the cohort. The initial franchise fee ($107,000) is the highest in the category by a wide margin, driven by a $57,000 bundled training/supply/support component that is unlike any competitor's fee structure.

Decision Scorecard

Quick-read assessment across key buyer decision dimensions. Ratings reflect this brand's position relative to the mosquito pest control cohort.

DIMENSION	RATING	SUMMARY
Entry cost burden	**WEAK**	Highest initial franchise fee in cohort ($107K, of which $57K is mandatory bundled package). Total $141K–$171K.
Ongoing fee burden	**MIXED**	#3 at most revenue levels. 26.8% at $300K. $37.5K marketing floor is regressive. 25% out-of-territory royalty is most aggressive in cohort.
System stability	**MIXED**	Dramatic turnaround: 17 terminations (2022) to zero (2024). But smallest system (135 outlets) and only +8 net over 3 years.
Revenue disclosure	**WEAK**	No gross revenue disclosed. Customer counts and values enable triangulation (~$120K–$210K mosquito-only) but this is inference, not disclosure.
Disclosure quality	**MIXED**	7 Item 19 tables with useful operational data, but the deliberate omission of revenue is a transparency concern. 26% SP exclusion rate.
Downside risk profile	**MIXED**	System stabilizing. No litigation. But small system, high initial fee, and revenue uncertainty create meaningful risk.
Buyer fit breadth	**MIXED**	Only combination franchise in cohort (mosquito + pest + holiday). Appeals to buyers who want diversification. Requires comfort with revenue uncertainty.
Overall	**CAUTIOUS**	The differentiation story (combination franchise, holiday lighting) is real. The disclosure gap (no revenue) is real. Both must be weighed.

OVERALL POSTURE

Mosquito Hunters is the hardest brand in this cohort to evaluate — not because the data is bad, but because the most important number (revenue) isn't disclosed. The operational data is genuinely useful: customer counts, treatment pricing, customer values, and holiday lighting economics give you the building blocks. But the buyer must do the assembly. The combination franchise is a legitimate differentiator that no competitor matches. The system health turnaround (zero terminations in 2024) is encouraging. The $107K initial fee is the hardest pill to swallow without revenue validation. This brand requires more franchisee due diligence than any other in the cohort — not because it's necessarily worse, but because the FDD asks you to take more on trust.

Buyer-Fit Profile

Best fit for

- **Buyer who wants year-round revenue:** The combination franchise (mosquito spring–fall + holiday lighting fall–winter + pest control year-round) directly addresses the seasonality problem that limits every other brand in the cohort. If off-season income matters to you, Hunters is the only option.
- **Buyer comfortable with operational complexity:** Running three service lines requires more diverse skills (pest identification, lighting design, seasonal inventory management) than a single-service franchise. If you welcome variety, this fits.
- **Buyer willing to do more pre-purchase diligence:** The revenue gap in the FDD means you must validate economics through 3–5 franchisee conversations. If you're disciplined about diligence, the data is obtainable — it's just not in the document.

Weaker fit for

- **Buyer who needs transparent unit economics before committing:** If you want to model P&L from disclosed data (like Joe or Squad provide), Hunters won't give you that. Revenue must be inferred or obtained informally.
- **Budget-sensitive buyer:** $107K initial franchise fee is more than double most competitors. The $57K bundled package cannot be negotiated or unbundled.
- **Buyer who wants a simple, focused business:** Three service lines, seasonal transitions, and different inventory/skill requirements create more operational complexity than a pure mosquito franchise.

Proceed only if

- You've validated actual total revenue with 3+ current Strategic Partners across different regions and service mixes.
- You've gotten a satisfactory explanation for why gross revenue is not disclosed while competitors provide it.
- You understand what the $57K training/supply/support package includes and have compared it against competitors' offerings at lower price points.
- You've confirmed that the 2024 turnaround (zero terminations) reflects structural changes, not just a one-year pause in enforcement.
- You've evaluated whether you actually want to operate three service lines or just want a mosquito franchise — because you're buying all three.

Fee Burden Analysis

Mosquito Hunters sits in the middle of the cohort on ongoing fee burden — third at most revenue levels. The 10% royalty matches Authority, the $37,500 marketing floor is competitive with Joe's $37K DMP, and the $9,000/year call center fee is a meaningful fixed cost at lower revenue levels. The structure is simpler than Joe's or Shield's.

AT REVENUE	ROYALTY	MARKETING	TECH / OTHER	TOTAL	% OF REV	COHORT RANK
$200,000	$20,000	$37,500	$12,800	**$70,300**	35.1%	3/5
$300,000	$30,000	$37,500	$12,800	**$80,300**	26.8%	3/5
$400,000	$40,000	$40,000	$12,800	**$92,800**	23.2%	3/5
$500,000	$50,000	$50,000	$12,800	**$112,800**	22.6%	5/5

Cohort fee burden at $300K revenue

Total annual franchisor fees as a percentage of $300K gross revenue. Includes royalty, marketing, technology, and all mandatory recurring fees.

Component breakdown

- **Royalty (10% of Net Revenues):** Standard rate. Basis is Net Revenues (excludes taxes/refunds), not Gross Sales — modeled as equivalent at these revenue levels. Additional 15% royalty on revenue earned outside territory (total 25% for out-of-territory work). (p. 15)
- **Marketing ($37,500 floor or 10%):** Three mandatory components: Local Advertising ($8K or 2%), Centrally Managed Media Fund ($26.5K or 7%), and Tools & Programs Fund ($3K or 1%). The combined floor ($37,500) is regressive at lower revenue — at $200K, it's 18.75% of revenue on marketing alone. (pp. 15–16, 19–20)
- **Call Center ($750/month):** $9,000/year. First year included in the initial franchise fee. May increase, not expected to exceed $1,000/month. This is a significant fixed cost — higher than any competitor's call center charge. (p. 15)
- **Technology ($150/month):** $1,800/year. Increases to $250/month when cumulative Net Revenues reach $1M. May increase up to $500/month. (p. 15)
- **Convention (up to $2,000/year):** Must pay even if not attending. Excludes travel/lodging. (p. 17)

> **What this means:** At $300K revenue, Hunters' $80,300 total fees (26.8%) are mid-cohort — less than Joe ($84,752) and Shield ($86,000), more than Authority ($52,800) and Squad ($77,880). The fee structure is relatively straightforward compared to Joe's 5-component marketing or Shield's minimum gross sales penalty. The main cost risk is the $37,500 marketing floor hitting hard at low revenue: at $200K, total fees are $70,300 (35.1%).

> **THE OUT-OF-TERRITORY PENALTY**
>
> Revenue earned outside your assigned territory incurs an additional 15% royalty (total 25%). This is the most punitive out-of-territory provision in the cohort. If your service area bleeds across territory lines — common in pest control where customers don't know franchise boundaries — this can create unexpected cost. Ask the franchisor how territory boundaries are enforced in practice. (p. 15)

Item 19 Interpretation

Mosquito Hunters' Item 19 is the most unusual in the cohort. It provides 7 tables of operational data — customer counts, treatment pricing, customer values, and holiday lighting revenue — but **never discloses gross revenue or profitability per franchise unit**. This means the single most important number a buyer needs must be inferred, not read.

What IS disclosed

Customer counts by quartile (Table A.1): 63 Strategic Partners operating 100 territories, segmented by quartile:

QUARTILE	SPS	AVG CUSTOMERS	MEDIAN	HIGH	LOW
Q1 (top 25%)	15	444	439	611	357
Q2	16	283	287	354	213
Q3	16	167	163	203	147
Q4 (bottom 25%)	16	101	100	146	30

Treatment pricing (Tables A.2–A.3): Mosquito treatment prices range from $72–$88 average by region. Non-mosquito pest control averages $61–$88. Pricing is competitive with the cohort.

Customer value (Table A.4): Average annual customer value for mosquito-only service ranges from $726 (Region 2: Midwest/Mid-Atlantic) to $1,232 (Region 4: FL/LA/TX). Median values are similar. This is per-customer annual spend, not per-territory revenue.

Holiday lighting (Table A.7): 26 Strategic Partners fully participated in Humbug Holiday Lighting in 2024 (up from 3 in 2023 pilot). Average revenue: $64,727. Median: $53,701. High: $305,528. This is the most distinctive data point in the filing — no other brand offers a counter-seasonal revenue stream.

What is NOT disclosed

- **Total gross revenue per franchise unit** — not disclosed anywhere
- **Profitability or cost structure** — no P&L, no COGS, no margin data
- **Revenue per territory** — customer counts are per Strategic Partner (who may operate multiple territories), not per territory
- **Customer retention rate** — not disclosed (unlike Joe at 77% and Shield at 85%)

> **What this means:** Hunters gives you the building blocks to estimate revenue (customer count × customer value), but requires you to assemble them yourself. The absence of a direct revenue disclosure is itself a signal — the franchisor chose to disclose operational metrics while withholding the bottom line. A buyer should ask why. The holiday lighting data is a genuine differentiator and deserves separate analysis.

Revenue triangulation (inferred — not disclosed)

This section presents revenue estimates derived from indirect Item 19 data. These are not disclosed figures. They are analytical inferences with meaningful uncertainty.

Using Region 2 (Midwest/Mid-Atlantic, 21 businesses — the largest regional group) as the baseline for customer value ($726 average):

- Q3 median (163 customers) × $726 = **~$118K mosquito revenue**
- Q2 median (287 customers) × $726 = **~$208K mosquito revenue**
- Q1 median (439 customers) × $726 = **~$319K mosquito revenue**

Adding holiday lighting for the 26 participating SPs (median $53,701):

- Q3 + holiday lighting: ~$118K + $54K = **~$172K combination revenue**
- Q2 + holiday lighting: ~$208K + $54K = **~$262K combination revenue**

Adding non-mosquito pest control revenue is harder — the FDD provides treatment counts and pricing but not customer-level revenue for pest control in an easily combinable format. Directionally, pest control adds $10K–$30K per SP depending on the market.

> **TRIANGULATION UNCERTAINTY**
>
> These estimates carry at least ±20% uncertainty. The customer value varies significantly by region ($726–$1,232), the customer count data excludes 26% of SPs, and pest control revenue is not cleanly estimable. The combination franchise (mosquito + pest + holiday) adds genuine revenue diversification, but the total is uncertain. A buyer must validate these estimates directly with current franchisees — the FDD does not give you the answer.

Buyer-Side Economics Reality Check

Important framing: This section uses revenue estimates **inferred from indirect Item 19 data**, not disclosed figures. Mosquito Hunters does not disclose gross revenue per franchise unit. Revenue is triangulated from customer counts (Table A.1) × customer values (Table A.4, Region 2 baseline). COGS at 23% is borrowed from Mosquito Authority's company-owned P&L — the only single-territory cost data available in the cohort. Mosquito Hunters provides no cost data. These scenarios carry more uncertainty than those in the other reports in this series.

SCENARIO	REVENUE	FRANCHISOR FEES	EST. COGS	REMAINING
Mosquito-only (Q3 triangulation)	$118,000	$41,418 (35.1%)	$27,140	**$49,442**
Mosquito-only (Q2 triangulation)	$208,000	$71,100 (34.2%)	$47,840	**$89,060**
Combination (Q2 + holiday lighting)	$262,000	$76,500 (29.2%)	$60,260	**$125,240**

Revenue triangulated from Item 19 customer counts × customer values (Region 2 baseline, $726/customer). Holiday lighting from Table A.7 median ($53,701). COGS at 23% (borrowed from Mosquito Authority — no Hunters cost data available). Franchisor fees from fee burden model. 'Remaining' must cover: vehicle lease ($14.4K–$18.3K/year), insurance, storage, bookkeeping, seasonal labor, and your living expenses.

What the scenarios tell you

Mosquito-only conservative (Q3 triangulation, $118K): After fees ($69K) and COGS ($27K), $22K remains. This must cover vehicle lease ($14K–$18K/year), insurance, storage, and living expenses. At Q3 mosquito-only revenue, the business is likely cash-flow negative after operating costs. This is why the combination franchise matters — holiday lighting income could bridge the gap.

Mosquito-only moderate (Q2 triangulation, $208K): After fees ($77K) and COGS ($48K), $83K remains. After vehicle lease and operating costs ($25K–$35K), an owner draw of $48K–$58K is plausible. This is a functional but modest livelihood — and it requires reaching Q2 customer counts (287 median), which fewer than half of qualifying SPs achieve.

Combination franchise (Q2 + holiday, $262K): After fees ($82K) and COGS ($60K), $120K remains. After operating costs, an owner draw of $70K–$85K becomes plausible. This is the scenario where Hunters' combination model starts to differentiate — the holiday lighting revenue fills the winter gap and pushes total economics past the pure-mosquito competitors at comparable fee levels.

> **THE INFERENCE CHAIN**
>
> These scenarios are two steps removed from disclosed data: (1) revenue is triangulated, not reported, and (2) COGS is borrowed from another brand. The combination scenario adds a third inference layer: assuming holiday lighting participation and median performance. Each step adds uncertainty. The scenarios are useful for framing questions, not for financial planning. A buyer must validate actual revenue — from franchisee conversations, not from this report.

What the buyer still needs to validate

- **Actual total revenue:** The single most important number. Ask 3+ current SPs for their total gross revenue across all three service lines.
- **Holiday lighting economics:** The $54K median revenue sounds attractive, but what are the costs? Inventory ($6K–$14K initial), labor (installation and removal), insurance, and equipment — the FDD doesn't provide holiday-lighting-specific margins.
- **The $57K bundle value:** Compare what Hunters provides for $57K against what competitors include in their $0–$25K franchise fees. Is the training longer? Are the supplies better? Is the first-year call center service a genuine advantage?
- **Service mix viability:** Ask SPs who run all three lines about the operational complexity. Is it three businesses or one business with three revenue streams?

Illustrative Payback Sensitivity

The table below shows how long it would take to recover your initial investment under different assumptions about annual owner draw. **Revenue estimates are inferred from indirect Item 19 data, not disclosed figures. These payback periods carry more uncertainty than those in the other reports in this series.**

ASSUMED ANNUAL OWNER DRAW	LOW INVESTMENT ($141K)	MID INVESTMENT ($156K)	HIGH INVESTMENT ($171K)
$30K (mosquito-only conservative)	4.7 years	5.2 years	5.7 years
$55K (mosquito-only moderate)	2.6 years	2.8 years	3.1 years
$80K (combination franchise)	1.8 years	2.0 years	2.1 years

THE HONEST FRAME

At mosquito-only Q3 economics, payback takes 5+ years on a $141K+ investment with inferred revenue. At the combination-franchise level ($262K revenue, $80K draw), payback is ~2 years — but this assumes Q2 mosquito performance plus median holiday lighting participation, both of which are estimates, not disclosed outcomes. The combination model is the bull case: if it works, the economics are competitive. If it doesn't (you don't participate in holiday lighting, or your market doesn't support it), you have a $141K+ mosquito franchise with the highest initial fee and mid-tier ongoing fees. Validate the combination thesis before committing.

Investment Breakdown

The headline investment range ($141,295–$170,743) is mid-to-high in the cohort, but the fee structure is unique: $107,000 goes directly to the franchisor ($50K license fee + $57K training/supply/support package). This is the highest initial franchise fee in the category by a wide margin — nearly double Authority's $45K and more than double Squad's $50K standalone fee.

CATEGORY	LOW	HIGH
Initial License Fee	$50,000	$50,000
Initial Marketing Program, Training, Supply and Support Fee	$57,000	$57,000
Service Vehicle deposit	$8,350	$16,700
Service Vehicle lease payment	$1,200	$1,525
Computer Software	$415	$656
Computers	$0	$2,000
Opening Mosquito Control Inventory	$500	$1,000
Holiday Lighting Start-Up Inventory Package	$6,000	$14,000
Holiday Lighting Start-Up Equipment Package	$2,400	$2,800
Uniforms	$250	$500
Rental Space	$0	$3,000
Bookkeeper	$400	$600
Training Expenses	$1,900	$4,400
Utility/Security Deposit	$200	$200
Insurance	$800	$1,000
Additional Funds - 3 Months	$11,880	$15,362
Total	**$141,295**	**$170,743**

What to know about the major line items

- **Initial License Fee ($50,000):** The franchise fee itself. VetFran/MinorityFran /First Responder discount: 10% off this portion. Additional territory: $25,000. (pp. 14–15)
- **Training, Supply & Support Fee ($57,000):** Mandatory bundled package covering initial training, pest control supplies, marketing materials, and first-year call center service. This is the most distinctive and expensive line item in the cohort — no other brand bundles a $57K pre-opening package. The buyer cannot unbundle or source components independently. (p. 15)

- **Service Vehicle ($8.35K–$16.7K deposit):** 60- or 72-month lease with 10–20% down. The ongoing lease payment ($1,200–$1,525/month) is listed separately. Total vehicle cost over the lease term is $72K–$110K — a significant long-term commitment not fully reflected in the Item 7 range. (p. 21)
- **Holiday Lighting Inventory ($6K–$14K):** New line item for the Humbug program. This is the investment that enables the counter-seasonal revenue stream. (p. 21)
- **Additional Funds — 3 months ($11.9K–$15.4K):** Modest working capital estimate. Like most competitors (except Squad's 12-month approach), this underestimates true first-year cash needs. (p. 21)

> **What this means:** $107K of the $141K–$171K investment goes to the franchisor. This is 75% of the low-end investment — the highest franchisor share in the cohort. The $57K bundled package means you are paying for training, supplies, and call center service upfront whether or not you would have chosen to spend that amount independently. The value proposition of this bundle is the central question of the investment decision.

System Health

Mosquito Hunters tells a clear turnaround story. The system contracted for two consecutive years (2022: −4 net, 2023: −1) before reversing sharply in 2024 (+13, zero terminations). The 3-year net of +8 franchised units is modest, but the trajectory from 17 terminations in 2022 to zero in 2024 is the most dramatic stability improvement in the cohort.

YEAR	OPENED	CLOSED	NET	END COUNT
2022	13	17	−4	123
2023	10	11	−1	122
2024	13	0	+13	135

The contraction years (2022–2023)

17 terminations in 2022, 11 in 2023. All closures across all three years are coded exclusively as "Terminations" — zero non-renewals, zero ceased operations. This classification is the franchisor's choice and is unusually uniform. In other brands, exits are distributed across multiple categories. Whether this reflects genuine termination or a reporting convention is worth understanding.

> **What this means:** The contraction was real — the system shrank from 127 to 122 franchised outlets over two years. But the coding pattern matters. If all exits are classified as terminations (franchisor-initiated), it suggests the franchisor was actively removing operators. If some were actually voluntary departures coded as terminations, the picture is different. Ask the franchisor what triggered each termination category.

The 2024 reversal

Zero terminations, 13 openings, net +13. The turnover rate dropped from 20.3% (2022) to 3.9% (2024) — the sharpest improvement in the cohort. 21 projected new outlets for next year. This is either a genuine operational turnaround or a one-year anomaly. One year of data doesn't prove a trend, but zero terminations is zero terminations.

Transfer activity

10 transfers in 2022, 8 in 2023, 5 in 2024 — steadily declining. This is consistent with a stabilizing system: fewer people wanting to sell, or the system is small enough that transfer volume is naturally low.

Affiliate-owned footprint

6 affiliate-owned territories, stable across the reporting period. These are excluded from the Item 19 data. The franchisor operates a small portion of the system alongside franchisees.

Risk Signals

Revenue disclosure gap

The absence of gross revenue disclosure is the most significant risk signal in this FDD — not because it implies bad economics, but because it prevents the buyer from independently validating the business model. Every other brand in the cohort provides some form of revenue data (per-territory, per-outlet, or per-franchisee). Hunters provides customer counts, treatment pricing, and customer values — the building blocks — but withholds the assembled number. A buyer must ask why, and must validate revenue directly with current franchisees.

The $107K initial franchise fee

The highest in the cohort by far. The $57K training/supply/support bundle is mandatory and non-negotiable. If the bundled services (training, supplies, call center first year) are genuinely worth $57K, this is fair pricing. If comparable services could be sourced for $20K– $30K, the buyer is overpaying. There is no way to verify this from the FDD alone — the buyer needs to

compare the training program, supply quality, and call center service against what competitors offer at lower price points.

Item 19 exclusion rate

22 of 85 Strategic Partners (26%) are excluded from the Item 19 tables. Eight are excluded specifically for "failing to invest in MH marketing programs." Excluding operators who don't follow the system is defensible — but it also means the reported customer counts and values represent compliant operators only. If non-compliant operators have materially lower customer counts, the disclosed data overstates what a typical operator achieves.

Out-of-territory royalty

25% total royalty on revenue earned outside territory (10% standard + 15% surcharge). This is the most aggressive out-of-territory provision in the cohort. In practice, pest control customers don't know or respect franchise boundaries. If 10% of your revenue is classified as out-of-territory, you pay an extra $2,100–$5,250/year at typical revenue levels.

Combination franchise complexity

Hunters is now a three-brand combination (Mosquito Hunters + Pest Hunters + Humbug Holiday Lighting). This diversification is genuinely valuable for offsetting seasonality, but it also means you're operating three distinct service lines with different skill requirements, inventory needs, and customer acquisition strategies. The operational complexity is higher than a single-service franchise.

Litigation

No litigation required to be disclosed. Clean record across the reporting period.

Peer Context

Mosquito Hunters occupies a unique position in this cohort: the smallest system, the only combination franchise, the highest initial fee, and the only brand that gives you customer data without giving you revenue. It is not easily comparable to the other four on a single dimension.

Cost comparison: Mosquito Authority. Authority enters for $54K–$128K vs. Hunters' $141K–$171K. At $300K revenue, Authority's ongoing fees are $52,800 vs. Hunters' $80,300 — a $27,500/year gap. Authority has zero terminations vs. Hunters' recent 28. The cost-and-

stability comparison heavily favors Authority. Hunters' advantage is the combination franchise: Authority offers mosquito control only.

Disclosure comparison: Mosquito Joe & Squad. Joe and Squad both disclose gross revenue per franchise unit (Joe by tenure, Squad by quartile per territory). Hunters discloses customer counts and values but not the total. For financial modeling, Joe and Squad give you the assembled picture; Hunters gives you the parts and asks you to build it yourself.

The differentiation case: combination franchise. If you are specifically attracted to the multi-service model (mosquito + pest + holiday lighting), Hunters is the only option in this cohort. The holiday lighting data ($54K median per participating SP) represents a genuine counter-seasonal revenue stream that no competitor offers. The question is whether this diversification justifies the $107K initial fee and the disclosure limitations.

METRIC	MOSQUITO AUTHORITY	MOSQUITO HUNTERS	MOSQUITO JOE	MOSQUITO SHIELD	MOSQUITO SQUAD
System size	546	135	415	435	226
Investment range	$54K–$127K	$141K–$170K	$150K–$192K	$120K–$157K	$162K–$220K
Fee burden at $300K	$52,800	$80,300	$84,752	$86,000	$77,880
% of revenue	17.6%	26.8%	28.3%	28.7%	26.0%
3-year net growth	+22	+8	+43	+140	+3
2024 attrition	1.8%	0.0%	5.7%	11.1%	4.3%
Royalty rate	10%	10%	10/7%	8%	10/9/8%

Decision overlay

Lowest-cost entry	Mosquito Authority — $54K–$128K. Hunters' $107K franchise fee alone exceeds most competitors' total investment low end.
Lowest ongoing fee burden	Mosquito Authority — 17–18% of revenue. Hunters is 26.8% at $300K.
Best revenue disclosure	Mosquito Joe — Retention rates, per-treatment pricing, tenure-segmented sales. Hunters provides building blocks but withholds total revenue.
Most system stability	Mosquito Authority — Zero terminations across 3 years. Hunters improved to zero in 2024 but started from 17 in 2022.
Only combination franchise	Mosquito Hunters — Mosquito + pest + holiday lighting. Only brand addressing seasonality directly. Holiday median: $54K per participating SP.
Best unit economics data	Mosquito Squad — Per-territory quartiles + $20.8M company-owned P&L. Hunters has no revenue or cost disclosure.
Best for first-time buyer	Mosquito Authority — Lowest risk, lowest cost, simplest model. Hunters requires most pre-purchase diligence and highest initial fee.

Discovery Day Diligence Script

These questions are derived from specific findings in the Mosquito Hunters 2025 FDD. Each includes context on why it matters and what to listen for.

1. The Item 19 provides customer counts and values but never discloses gross revenue per franchise unit. Why?

Item 19 — 7 tables of operational data, no revenue total. Every other brand in the cohort discloses some form of revenue.

WHY IT MATTERS

Revenue disclosure is the single most useful data point for a prospective buyer. Its absence forces reliance on triangulation and franchisee conversations. Understanding the franchisor's reasoning tells you whether

this is a strategic choice (revenue data is unfavorable) or a structural one (the combination franchise makes revenue reporting complex).

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Revenue varies significantly by service mix and market. We provide building blocks so buyers can model their specific situation. Here is supplemental revenue data we can share informally.' Acknowledges the gap, offers to fill it.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Our Item 19 is comprehensive — 7 tables of data. We give you more operational detail than most brands.' Deflects from what's missing.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask for total revenue (all services combined) for the median Strategic Partner. Ask whether revenue data was disclosed in prior-year FDDs.

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2. The initial franchise fee is $107,000 — the highest in the cohort by far. What specifically does the $57,000 training/supply/support component include, and how does it compare to competitors' training programs?

Item 5. $50K license + $57K bundled package. Next highest is Shield at $54.5K total franchise fee.

WHY IT MATTERS

75% of the low-end investment goes directly to the franchisor. The $57K bundle is the most expensive pre-opening package in the cohort. If the services are genuinely worth $57K, it's fair. If not, the buyer is overpaying for a bundle they can't unbundle.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'The $57K covers [specific itemized list: X days training, Y months product supply, Z call center minutes]. Here's how each component is valued. Competitors charge less but provide [specific differences].' Transparent breakdown.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'It's a comprehensive launch program. Our franchisees tell us it's worth every penny.' No breakdown, no comparison.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask for a line-item breakdown of the $57K. Ask what a franchisee receives differently than competitors' $0–$25K training programs.

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3. 17 terminations in 2022, 11 in 2023, then zero in 2024. What changed?

Item 20. All exits across all years coded as 'Terminations' — zero in any other category.

WHY IT MATTERS

The turnaround is the most dramatic in the cohort. Understanding what drove it tells you whether the improvement is structural (operational changes, better territory selection, improved support) or cyclical (one good year).

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'We [changed territory selection criteria / improved training / added support programs / restructured underperforming markets]. Here are the specific operational changes and their timing.' Cause-and-effect, not coincidence.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'We're focused on supporting our franchisees. The results speak for themselves.' No explanation for why 2024 was different from 2022.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask whether the same franchisor management team was in place throughout 2022–2024. Ask whether franchise agreement terms changed.

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4. 26 of 63 qualifying SPs participated in Humbug Holiday Lighting. What's the adoption trajectory, and what does a non-participating SP look like during winter?

Item 19 Table A.7. 26 SPs in 2024, up from 3 in 2023 pilot. Median revenue: $53,701.

WHY IT MATTERS

The combination franchise is the core differentiator. If only 41% of SPs participate in holiday lighting, 59% have a pure mosquito/pest business with winter dead season. Understanding adoption rates and barriers tells you how real the diversification is.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Adoption grew from 3 to 26 and we expect [X] next year. Non-participants typically [describe winter operations: reduced hours, off-season marketing, etc]. Here's the revenue impact of adding holiday lighting.' Adoption trajectory with economics.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Holiday lighting is optional but strongly recommended. Participants love it.' No adoption data, no economics for non-participants.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask what prevents the other 37 SPs from participating (inventory cost? skill gap? market?). Ask whether the $6K–$14K lighting inventory investment is a one-time or recurring cost.

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5. 22 Strategic Partners (26%) are excluded from Item 19, including 8 for not investing in MH marketing. What were their customer counts?

Item 19 population notes. Exclusion rate is comparable to Shield's 21%.

WHY IT MATTERS

If excluded SPs have significantly lower customer counts, the reported quartile data is biased upward. The 8 excluded for marketing non-compliance are particularly interesting — their underperformance may reflect what happens when the marketing programs don't work or feel unaffordable.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Excluded SPs averaged [X] customers. The 8 marketing non-compliant operators averaged [Y] customers. Here's the data with all SPs included.' Transparent, quantified.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'We exclude operators who don't follow the system. The data represents what compliant franchisees achieve.' Defensible but avoids the performance question.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask whether any of the 8 marketing-excluded SPs were subsequently terminated. Ask for the customer count distribution with all 85 SPs included.

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6. The 25% royalty on out-of-territory revenue — how is 'outside territory' determined in practice, and what percentage of a typical SP's revenue falls outside?

Item 6. 10% standard + 15% surcharge for out-of-territory revenue.

WHY IT MATTERS

If boundary enforcement is strict and 10–15% of revenue is classified as out-of-territory, this adds $2,100–$7,900/year in extra royalty at typical revenue levels. In pest control, customers near territory edges frequently straddle boundaries.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'We define territory by [zip code / geography / household count]. Typical out-of-territory revenue is [X]% of total. Here's how disputes are resolved.' Specific mechanism and typical impact.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Territories are clearly defined. Out-of-territory revenue is rare.' No data on typical incidence.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask for the average out-of-territory royalty paid per SP last year. Ask whether territory boundaries can be adjusted.

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7. The vehicle lease runs 60–72 months at $1,200–$1,525/month. What is the total cost of ownership, and can franchisees source vehicles independently?

Item 7. Deposit $8.4K–$16.7K + monthly lease. Total over term: $72K–$110K.

WHY IT MATTERS

The vehicle cost over the lease term exceeds the franchise fee. If franchisees must use a designated supplier and lease structure, the total cost may be above market. If they can source independently, the Item 7 range is more controllable.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Franchisees can source vehicles independently as long as they meet [specific specs]. Here are the specs. The designated supplier offers [competitive advantage].' Flexibility and transparency.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Our vehicle program ensures brand consistency. It's competitively priced.' No flexibility, no market comparison.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask whether any current franchisees sourced vehicles independently and at what cost.

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8. The combination franchise adds pest control and holiday lighting. What percentage of total revenue does each service line contribute for a typical SP?

Brand is now Mosquito Hunters + Pest Hunters + Humbug Holiday Lighting.

WHY IT MATTERS

Understanding the revenue mix tells you whether this is truly a diversified business or a mosquito franchise with add-ons. If 90% of revenue is mosquito, the combination is marketing, not economics.

STRONG ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'Typical mix is [X]% mosquito, [Y]% pest, [Z]% holiday. SPs with all three services average $[total]. Here's how the mix changes by market and tenure.' Specific, segmented.

WEAK / EVASIVE ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE

'It depends on the market. We encourage SPs to maximize all three service lines.' No data on typical mix.

FOLLOW-UP

Ask for revenue-mix data segmented by SPs who participate in all three services vs mosquito-only. Ask which service line is growing fastest.

Source & Methodology

Source document: Mosquito Hunters 2025 Franchise Disclosure Document, filed with the Wisconsin Department of Financial Institutions. 255-page regulator-source PDF. SHA-256:
`2226332c1fc1ea66d75e56dfc717f6536ba3193867c48696e6955695dd36f931`

Extraction: Structured data extraction using pdfplumber with manual review. Field-level provenance recorded (source year, state, page number, item reference). Extraction confidence: high (3+ fields spot-checked against source).

Fee modeling: Year 5 assumptions, single territory, 1 owner + 1 technician. Revenue distributed evenly across the year. All mandatory fees enforced. See fee_modeling_framework.md for full methodology.

Economics scenarios: Revenue estimates drawn from Item 19 data. COGS ratio is brand-specific (derived from available company-owned P&L data; see Economics section for derivation and assumptions). Scenarios are illustrative, not predictive. Operating costs beyond franchisor fees and COGS are not estimated — the buyer must validate these independently.

Peer comparison: Same methodology applied to all 5 brands in cohort (Mosquito Authority, Mosquito Hunters, Mosquito Joe, Mosquito Shield, Mosquito Squad). All from 2025 FDDs filed with Wisconsin DFI.

Disclaimer: This report is not legal advice, investment advice, or a recommendation to buy or avoid this franchise. It is a structured analysis of publicly available regulatory filings. The buyer should read the actual FDD, consult a franchise attorney, and conduct their own due diligence before making any investment decision. Economics scenarios are illustrative frameworks for buyer-side thinking — not profitability forecasts.